

# Kritika Goyal

## Senior Software Engineer

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### Summary

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Senior Software Engineer with 9+ years of experience building scalable backend systems, distributed platforms, and customer-facing e-commerce products. Strong expertise in Java, Spring Boot, microservices, event-driven architecture, Kubernetes, AWS, Kafka, Redis, and system design, with recent experience building AI-powered product discovery using Python, FastAPI, Pydantic AI, and OpenAI. Currently at Zalando, working on high-traffic product page and smart shopping assistant systems that help customers discover relevant fashion products with low-latency and reliable backend services. Proven track record of improving reliability, performance, rollout safety, and developer confidence across customer-facing platforms.

### Skills

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#### Languages

Java, SQL, Kotlin

#### Cloud & Infrastructure

AWS, Docker, Kubernetes

#### Messaging & Eventing

Kafka, Nakadi, SQS

#### AI-Assisted Development

Claude Code, GitHub Copilot, ChatGPT

#### Practices

System Design, Performance Optimization, Reliability Engineering, CI/CD, A/B Testing, Feature Rollouts

#### Backend

Spring Boot, REST APIs, FastAPI, Microservices, Distributed Systems

#### Database & Caching

MySQL, DynamoDB, Redis

#### Testing & QA

JUnit, Postman, Testcontainers

#### Monitoring & Observability

Prometheus, Grafana, Lightstep

#### AI / LLM

OpenAI API, Pydantic AI, LLM-based workflows, structured outputs, prompt design, AI-assisted product discovery

### Work Experience

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#### Senior Software Engineer, Zalando SE

09/2022 – Present  
Berlin, Germany

- Built a chat-based smart shopping assistant for fashion product discovery, allowing customers to find relevant products through natural language conversations using FastAPI, Pydantic AI, OpenAI, and structured catalogue-search workflows. Designed intent extraction, structured LLM responses, and validation flows to convert customer queries into reliable product filters and search actions.
- Built and maintained backend services for Zalando’s high-traffic Product Details Page platform, aggregating catalog, pricing, and localisation data for millions of customers with low-latency performance requirements.
- Contributed to low-latency product page delivery, supporting p95 latency around 100 ms at scale.
- Owned experimentation and feature rollout infrastructure for the Product Page, enabling A/B testing and controlled rollout of changes across Zalando markets.
- Improved rollout safety and platform reliability through better observability, release controls, and production readiness practices.

- Previously worked on Returns and Checkout services handling around 200 RPM average and 800 RPM peak traffic, improving service reliability by 20%.
- Tech stack: Java, Spring Boot, Kubernetes, AWS, Redis, Nakadi, Git.

### **SDE III, Walmart Labs**

05/2019 – 03/2022  
Bengaluru, India

- Engineered key components of the Multi-Channel Sourcing Engine (MCSE) to optimize order delivery routes and ensure accurate delivery date predictions for Walmart.com.
- Spearheaded development of core features in the Customer Care Application (CCA), used by 5000+ agents to manage customer orders, refunds, and adjustments.
- Built a robust regression framework from scratch, significantly improving release confidence and test coverage across the platform.

### **Software Development Engineer, Freecharge Payment Technologies**

04/2018 – 05/2019  
Gurgaon, India

- Designed and developed critical components of the Fulfillment System, enabling smooth settlement of transactions with partner merchants via RESTful APIs.
- Launched Gift Card functionality from the ground up, adding a new revenue stream and enhancing product offerings.

Enhanced system performance and reliability using Spring, Hibernate, Redis, and SQS.

### **Software Engineer, Libsys Limited**

07/2016 – 04/2018  
Gurgaon, India

Took complete ownership of the Results module in the LSAcademia platform, ensuring accurate and timely academic reporting.

## **Education**

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### **Bachelor of Technology, Banasthali University**

07/2012 – 04/2016

## **Internships**

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### **CDAC, Pune**

07/2015 – 11/2015

Created a web based interface for Spell-checking, Grammar-checking, Style-checking and Word-processing with high accuracy and efficiency. Wrote a research paper for the same which was accepted in International Conference on Electrical, Electronics, and Optimization Techniques (ICEEOT) - 2016.